



COMING TOGETHER: NDA meets to endorse Advani

person Sushma Swaraj pointed out that despite rumours, Vajpayee still remained the chairperson and that the coalition would continue to look to him for guidance. "When someone becomes old he does not become less important," she said.

The opposition chief ministers complained of step-brotherly treatment by UPA. For instance, Chhattisgarh's Raman Singh said that ever since he had announced the Rs 3 per-kg rice scheme the Centre had stopped giving him his quota of 7,000 metric tonne of rice. The meeting also discussed the strategy for the coming elections. It's a far cry from the Congress where their apparent Rahul Gandhi complained recently that the Congress always seems to lag behind the BJP in poll preparedness.

by Priya Sahgal

A Meeting of Minds

DELHI Leader of the Opposition L.K. Advani called the recent NDA meeting a "significant milestone". The BJP leader was alluding to the fact that for the first time after the 2004 elections, all the NDA leaders and chief ministers—except the Trinamool

Congress—had come together at the same platform. This was also a personal milestone for Advani—this was the first time that an NDA meeting had been hosted at his residence and the main issue on the agenda was to endorse him as the alliance's

prime-ministerial choice. It was a moment he had long been waiting for.

Earlier, the meetings were held at NDA chairperson Atal Behari Vajpayee's residence but due to his ill-health the venue had been shifted this time. BJP spokes-

THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

If the delimitation commission's recommendations on remapping of constituencies are accepted, the Congress's babalog won't be the only ones to suffer. More than half of RJD MPs will be scurrying around for a new seat.

VOICES



"After the results of the Gujarat elections were declared, Sonia Gandhi was admitted to hospital. Gujarat prayed for her recovery."

Narendra Modi, Gujarat chief minister

"We can make instant coffee, but we cannot produce instant leaders in politics. I am the true political heir of MGR. Nobody can claim any right over his legacy."

J. Jayalalithaa, AIADMK chief

"All Dalai Lamas have been male. Now we want a female Dalai Lama. She will obviously be more attractive so we will have more followers."

Dalai Lama, Tibetan spiritual leader

"I am deeply pained at the experience I had at the Kadampuzha Devi temple (in Kerala). Even cats and rats can go near God. Why am I barred?"

K.J. Yesudas, singer

"There are going to be a couple of people out of 1.2 billion who don't like you. That's very hard, but it's very hard for everyone to like you as well."

Sania Mirza, tennis player

